

Action

Some specific places in Halifax that are addressing the issue of the alarming rate of unemployment within the youth are more popular areas like Zatzman Sportsplex and Canada Games Centre that host different opportunities like a lifeguard to improve the skills needed to get a job or to work and improve your resume. We actually have experience with this in our group, as Lachlan McM actually has a job at the Canada Games Centre, even though he is 14, because the Canada Game Centre is really trying to combat issues with youth employment.

In Canada, there are countless programs to help provide jobs, and work experience to youth Programs like NSYEP (next step youth entrepreneurship program) and Canada Summer Jobs (such as camp counselor and leaders, which is volunteer work) provide internships and paid work (lifeguard, desk worker, gym attendant, field house attendant), locations like YMCA, and the community Canada Games Centre help young people (18 and under) learn skills, such as working with kids, first aid, dealing with transactions and many many more is addition to providing real world work experience. Many univdrstys all over Canada, in addition to schools like NSCC and Dal university which are in Nova Scotia, provide and offer co-op programs, many other groups such as volta labs and groups targeted toward Mi'kmaw, provide mentorship and support youth with the intention to help them start their individual careers.

The Youth Employment and Skills Strategy (YESS) is a Government of Canada initiative meant to help young people that are 15 - 30 years old to gain the skills and work experience needed to move into the labor market. It includes a variety of programs such as summer jobs, which provides a livable wage that can sustain employers to support in youth summer work placements. The strategy focuses mainly on supporting divorce youth and ensuring they have access to skill required to be successful in a work environment.

What the Government has been doing to help with the issue of youth employment has been working. We have a personal example of this, as Lachlan McM's brother was in the O2 program and shadowed as a physiotherapist. Now that he is in university, he has the job experience as a physiotherapist, and where he previously shadowed, now that place knows he's a good worker and he is ahead of the game and is now working full time there. This is an excellent example of how the O2 program (from the Government) helps provide excellent job experience to those who are wanting to start their careers the right way, with a good paying job that they actually want to work. Additionally, the Government has been providing these programs to directly address the difficulty's of youth employment.

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Youth **WORX**



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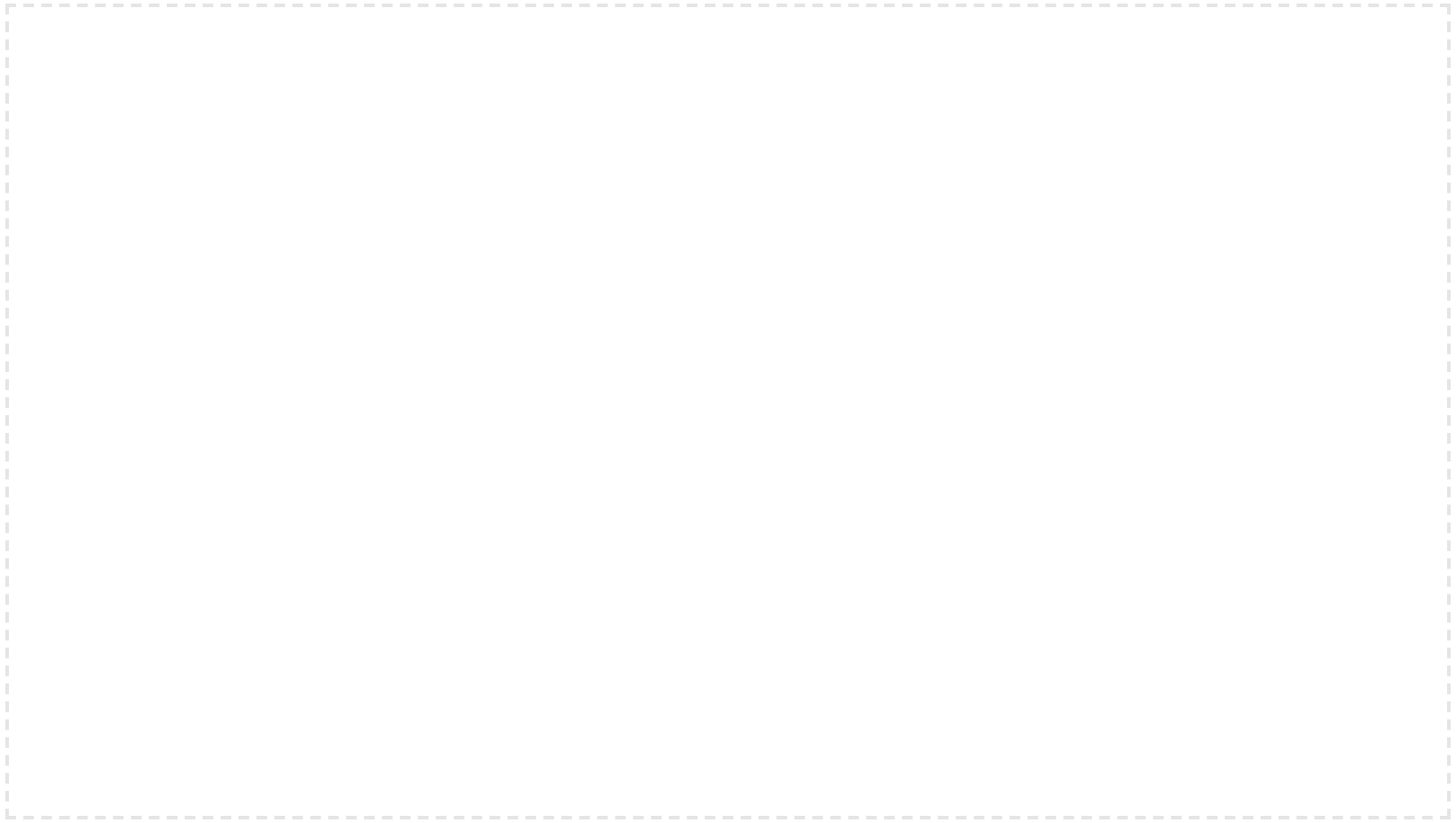
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